

Aside from the fact that conversation with Suzy feels, in itself, like self-care of the highest order, her insights come from a place of truly understanding what it means to be human and to be flawed, and to still deserve to feel cared for. She encourages the people she reaches through her books and social media, as well as her practice as a psychologist, to reframe the way that they think of self-care, rejecting the way that our culture often conflates looking after yourself with buying things for yourself.

‘Self-care has become commodified for sure,’ she says. ‘We need to move away from identifying self-care with products, or even practices. It needn’t be either of those things, we could actually take a look at self-care as a skill set. These are things that you don’t have to spend any money on to integrate into your life, but they do literally change the lens through which you see life unfolding.’

Suzy also has a refreshing take on mindfulness, with an awareness that many of us may have already heard of it, or even attempted to engage with it in a superficial or half-hearted way, and subsequently dismissed it. Again, it is a simple concept which has been commodified, and it’s now difficult to picture mindfulness without thinking about colouring books and such. But, as with most of these things, it’s about looking at that concept and asking yourself how we can apply it to our own lives in a way that makes sense to us, and in a way that’s going to enhance our experience of life, rather than detract from it. It’s the same with nutrition, exercise and – you guessed it –